

Sam Rivera

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Dear Northwind Labs hiring team,

At Meridian Logistics, I built the engineering organization from one person to 20+ engineers, defining the technical foundation and processes for a regulated fintech platform. I designed the backend systems and processes, including the TypeScript microservice framework and PostgreSQL schemas, and established the CI/CD pipelines and code review standards that enabled scalable, compliant development.

I led release management across four engineering teams, implementing a bi-weekly release cadence and aligning with regulatory milestones like custody launch and clearing approval. I also managed cross-functional incident response, ensuring technical investigations and coordination resolved issues in a high-compliance environment where platform failures had direct regulatory risk.

In change management, I coordinated audit readiness by drafting responses, conducting least-privilege access reviews, and converting audit findings into remediation items. I emphasized operational rigor by embedding tech debt cleanup into every sprint and maintaining a stable codebase across a growing team in a regulated setting. These experiences align with the responsibilities of leading Northwind Labs's billing platform, particularly in areas like data integrity, compliance, and cross-functional collaboration.

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